CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY | CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Email Marketing Course Handbook

"Build a list and turn subscribers into loyal customers."

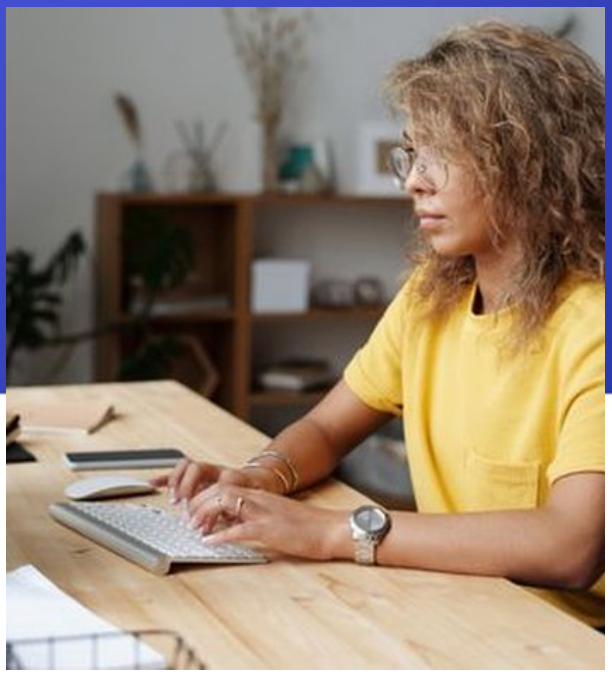


Retention & Direct Response Track | 6 Weeks | All Levels

28-Page Illustrated Edition

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Course Foreword



Email marketing quietly outperforms almost every other channel on return for money spent. Why? Because an email list is an audience you own outright, not rented from a social platform that can change its rules or bury your posts tomorrow.

For any business, freelancer or creator, learning email marketing means learning to build and profit from a direct relationship with people who chose to hear from you. It is a skill you can sell and one that pays a business back for years.

THE PRACTITIONER PROMISE

You will learn to grow an email list, choose the right tools, write emails people open and act on, automate sequences, personalise at scale, and improve with data.

Apply each chapter to a real or imagined business. The exercises build, step by step, into a complete email strategy you can actually run.

Published by CHRISCO Digital Academy under CHRISCO Youth Aflame (*CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches*), this 28-page course handbook explains every module clearly with visual diagrams, real East African case studies, and step-by-step labs. Reach our mentorship desk anytime at chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.



Key Learning Outcomes

01

Introduction to email marketing: Email reaches an audience you own directly.

02

Choosing an email platform: Use a proper email platform, not personal Gmail.

03

Automating email sequences: Set up sequences once; they run automatically.

04

Analytics and optimisation: A campaign coordinates emails toward one goal.

Across 6 Weeks of structured practice, each of the 8 modules is given a dedicated two-page spread: first unpacking the concept visually, then walking through a real field scenario and hands-on lab.

By Module 08, you will have built and verified a complete subscriber sequence ready to serve employers, clients, ministries, and communities with excellence.

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01
Foundations & Core Mindset

Module 01: Introduction to email marketing | Module 02: Building your email list

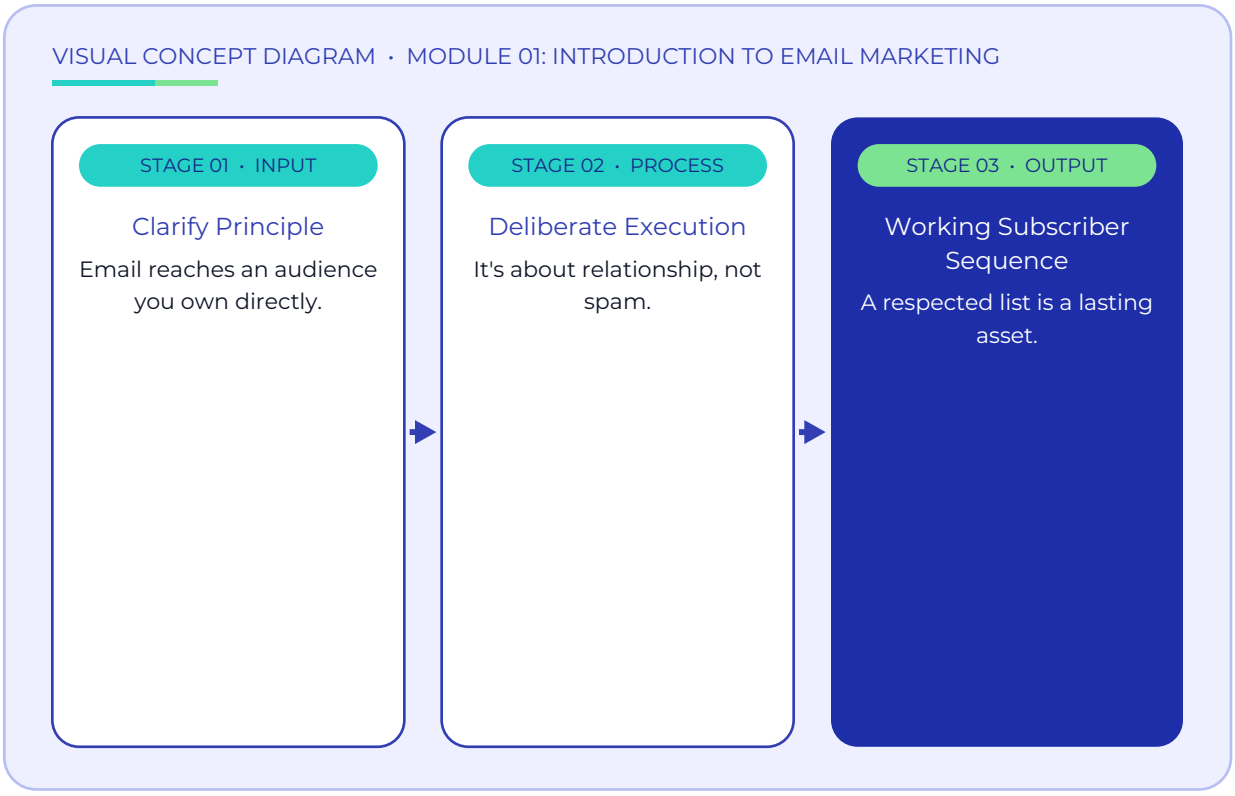
MODULE 01 · PART 1

1.1 Introduction to email marketing

Email marketing is using email to build relationships and drive sales, sending valuable, relevant messages to people who've given you permission to contact them. Unlike social media, you're not fighting an algorithm or renting attention; you reach subscribers directly. That ownership and directness are why email returns so much for every shilling spent.

The mindset that matters: email is about relationship, not spam. You earn the right to sell by consistently providing value and respecting the reader. Done well, your emails are welcomed, opened and acted on. Done badly (constant selling, irrelevant blasts), people unsubscribe. Treat your list as a privilege, and it becomes a powerful, lasting asset.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *introduction to email marketing* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real subscriber sequence. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that email reaches an audience you own directly., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.





MODULE 01 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A creator with a modest email list of a few hundred true fans launched a product and made more sales than a rival with tens of thousands of passive social followers, because email reached people directly and personally, and they trusted her.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Email Marketing workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT • MODULE 01

Your Practical Task: Write down why email marketing suits a business you know, and what value you could send its customers that they'd actually want.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 01 Key Takeaways

01

Email reaches an audience you own directly.

02

It's about relationship, not spam.

03

A respected list is a lasting asset.

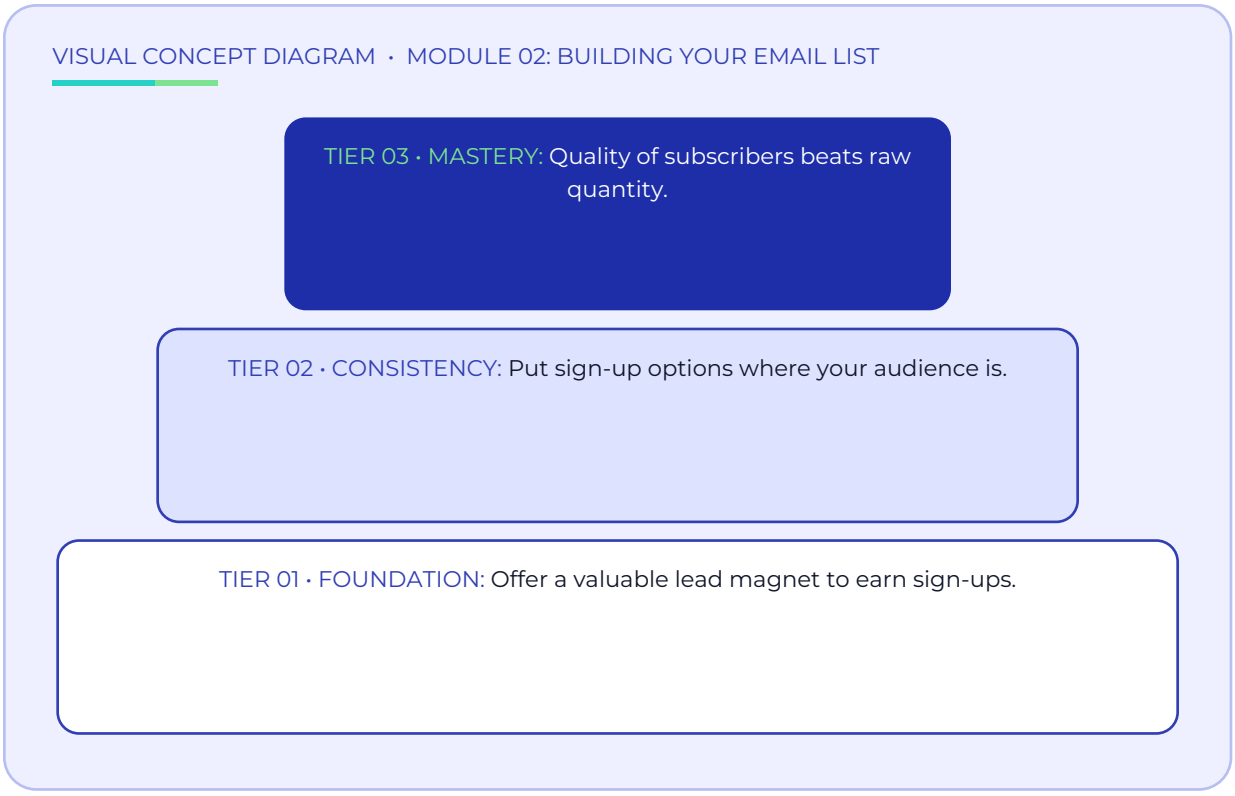
MODULE 02 · PART 1

1.2 Building your email list

You can't do email marketing without subscribers, and people won't hand over their email for nothing. You need a 'lead magnet', something valuable offered in exchange for signing up: a discount, a useful guide, a checklist, a free resource. The better and more relevant the offer, the faster your list grows with the right people.

Place sign-up opportunities where your audience is, on your website, social profiles, at checkout, in your content. Always get genuine permission (never buy or scrape lists, it's ineffective and often illegal). Focus on quality over sheer size: a smaller list of genuinely interested people is far more valuable than a huge list of the indifferent.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *building your email list* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real subscriber sequence. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that offer a valuable lead magnet to earn sign-ups., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.



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MODULE 02 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Building your email list

Core Rule:
Offer a valuable lead magnet to earn sign-ups.

Target Output:
Working subscriber sequence

MODULE 02 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
An online tutor offered a free 'exam preparation checklist' in exchange for an email. Students happily signed up, and she then nurtured them toward her paid classes. The free, relevant lead magnet built a list of exactly the right people.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Email Marketing workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 02

Your Practical Task: Design a lead magnet for your chosen business: what valuable free thing would its ideal customer gladly give their email for? Write its title.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 02 Key Takeaways

01

Offer a valuable lead magnet to earn sign-ups.

02

Put sign-up options where your audience is.

03

Quality of subscribers beats raw quantity.



02
Core Frameworks & Strategy

Module 03: Choosing an email platform | Module 04: Writing compelling emails

MODULE 03 · PART 1

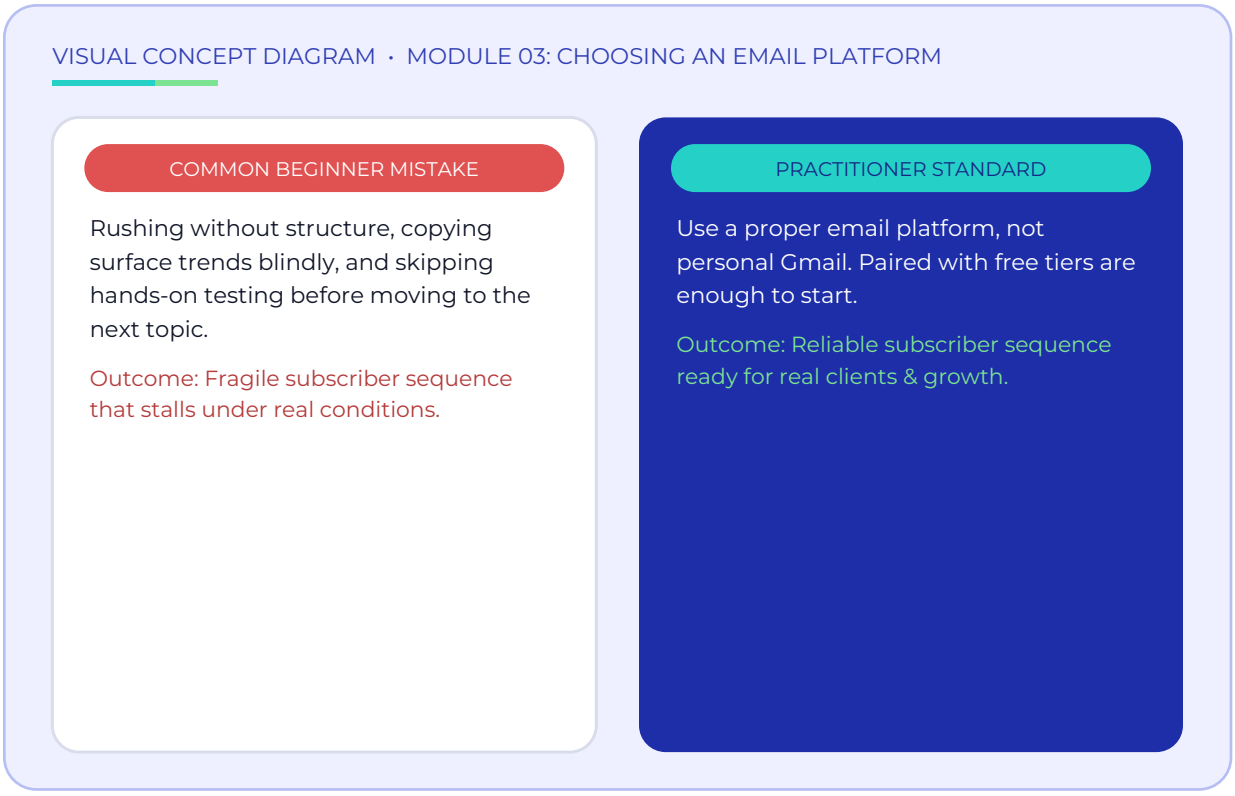
2.1 Choosing an email platform

You need an email marketing tool (like Mailchimp, MailerLite, and others) to manage subscribers, send bulk emails legally and professionally, and automate sequences, never use your personal Gmail for this. Most have free tiers generous enough for beginners, so cost is not a barrier to starting properly.

Choose based on ease of use and the features you'll actually need: list management, templates, automation, and analytics. Don't overthink it, pick a beginner-friendly platform, learn it well, and switch later only if you outgrow it. The tool matters less than how you use it; a simple platform used skilfully beats a powerful one used poorly.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *choosing an email platform* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real subscriber sequence. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that use a proper email platform, not personal gmail., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 03: CHOOSING AN EMAIL PLATFORM



MODULE 03 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Choosing an email platform

Core Rule:
Use a proper email platform, not personal Gmail.

Target Output:
Working subscriber sequence

MODULE 03 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A small business owner started with a free MailerLite account, imported her sign-ups, and sent her first professional newsletter with a ready template in an afternoon. The free tool did everything she needed to begin earning from email.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Email Marketing workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 03

Your Practical Task: Create a free account on a beginner-friendly email platform. Explore how to add a subscriber, use a template, and send a test email to yourself.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 03 Key Takeaways

01

Use a proper email platform, not personal Gmail.

02

Free tiers are enough to start.

03

Ease of use matters more than fancy features.

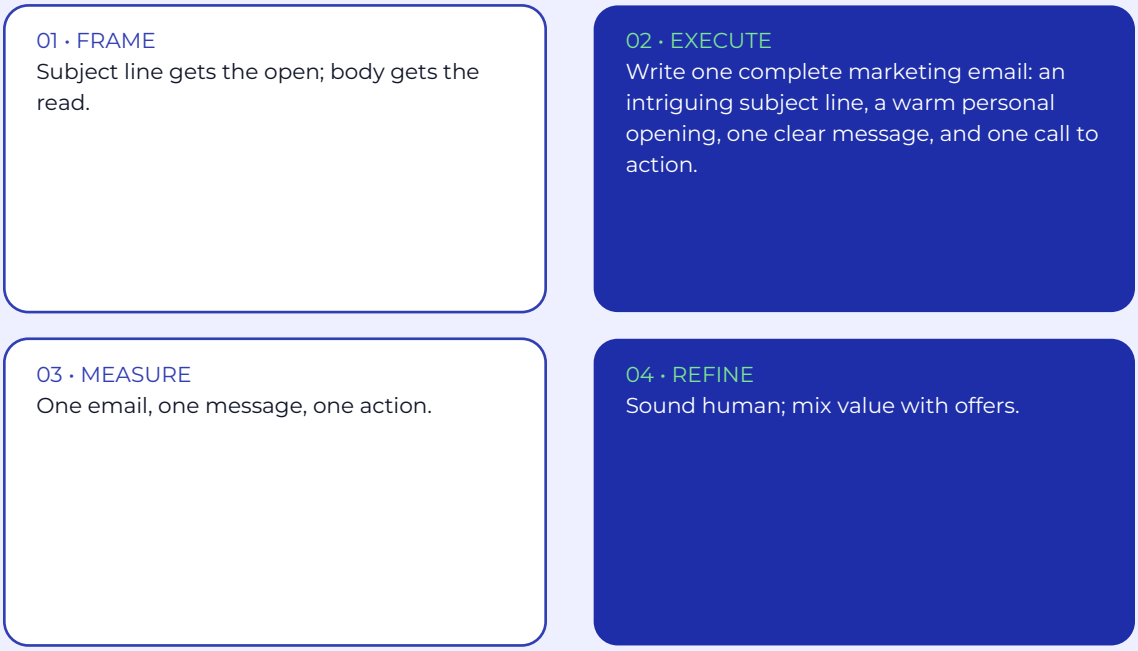
2.2 Writing compelling emails

A great marketing email has three jobs: get opened, get read, and get action. The subject line earns the open (make it intriguing or clearly valuable, never clickbait that disappoints). The body earns attention with a friendly, personal tone and one clear message. And a single, obvious call to action tells the reader exactly what to do next.

Write like a human talking to one person, not a corporation broadcasting. Keep it focused, resist cramming multiple offers into one email. Provide value or interest, not just constant selling, so people keep opening your future emails. Consistency of a welcome, valuable voice is what turns a list into loyal customers.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *writing compelling emails* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real subscriber sequence. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that subject line gets the open; body gets the read., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 04: WRITING COMPELLING EMAILS



MODULE 04 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Writing compelling emails

Core Rule:
Subject line gets the open; body gets the read.

Target Output:
Working subscriber sequence

MODULE 04 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A shop's emails were ignored until they switched from formal 'Dear valued customer' blasts to warm, personal notes with one clear offer and a friendly tone. Opens and sales rose, people respond to a human, not a megaphone.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Email Marketing workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 04

Your Practical Task: Write one complete marketing email: an intriguing subject line, a warm personal opening, one clear message, and one call to action.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 04 Key Takeaways

01

Subject line gets the open; body gets the read.

02

One email, one message, one action.

03

Sound human; mix value with offers.



03
Execution & Applied Mastery

Module 05: Automating email sequences | Module 06: Segmentation and personalisation

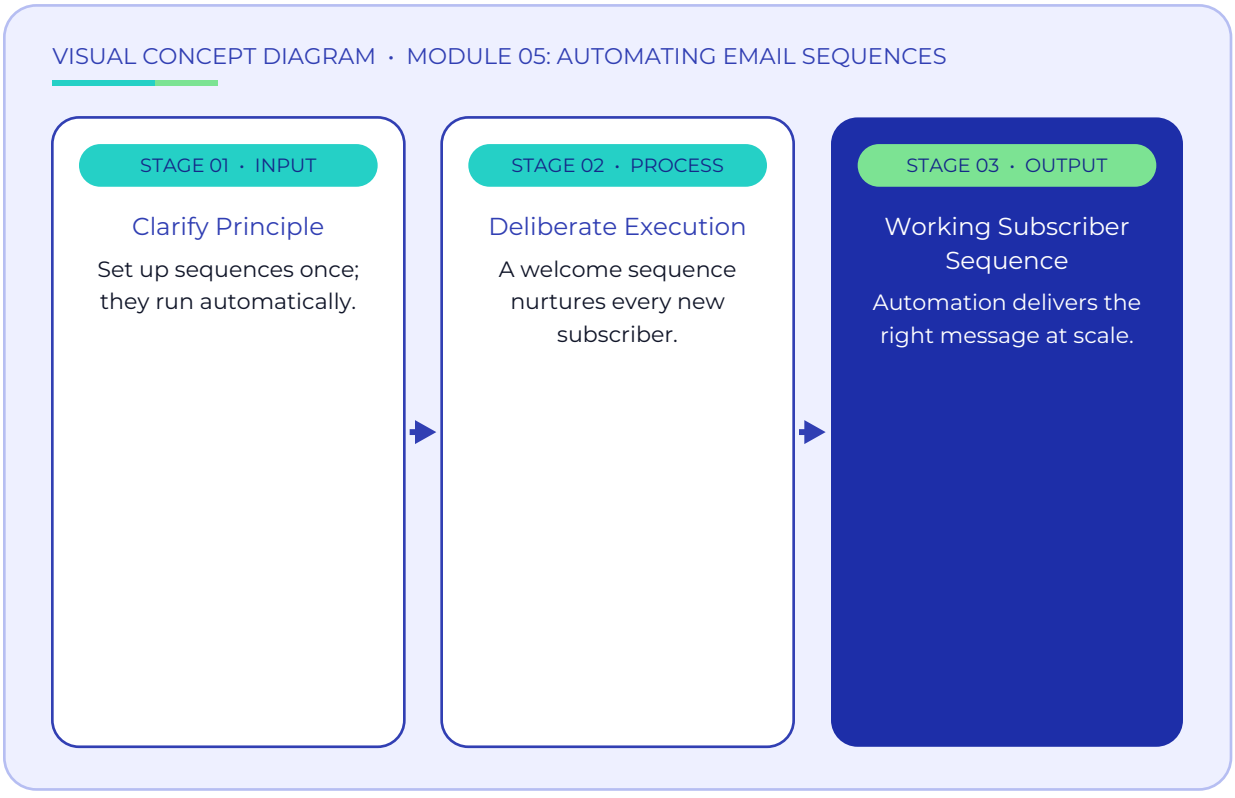
MODULE 05 · PART 1

3.1 Automating email sequences

Automation is email marketing's superpower: you set up sequences once, and they run automatically for every new subscriber. The most important is a 'welcome sequence', a series of emails that greets new subscribers, delivers value, tells your story, and gently leads them toward a purchase, all without you lifting a finger after setup.

Automations can also handle things like abandoned carts, post-purchase follow-ups, and re-engaging inactive subscribers. This means the right message reaches the right person at the right time, at scale, while you sleep. Setting up smart automations is what makes email marketing efficient and, frankly, close to passive income for a business.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *automating email sequences* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real subscriber sequence. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that set up sequences once; they run automatically., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.



MODULE 05 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Automating email sequences

Core Rule:
Set up sequences once; they run automatically.

Target Output:
Working subscriber sequence

MODULE 05 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
An online store set up a 3-email welcome sequence: a warm hello, a helpful tip, then a first-purchase discount. Every new subscriber now gets nurtured automatically, and a steady share buy, all running on autopilot after one setup.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Email Marketing workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 05

Your Practical Task: Outline a 3-email welcome sequence for your business: email 1 (welcome + value), email 2 (build trust/story), email 3 (a clear offer).

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 05 Key Takeaways

01

Set up sequences once; they run automatically.

02

A welcome sequence nurtures every new subscriber.

03

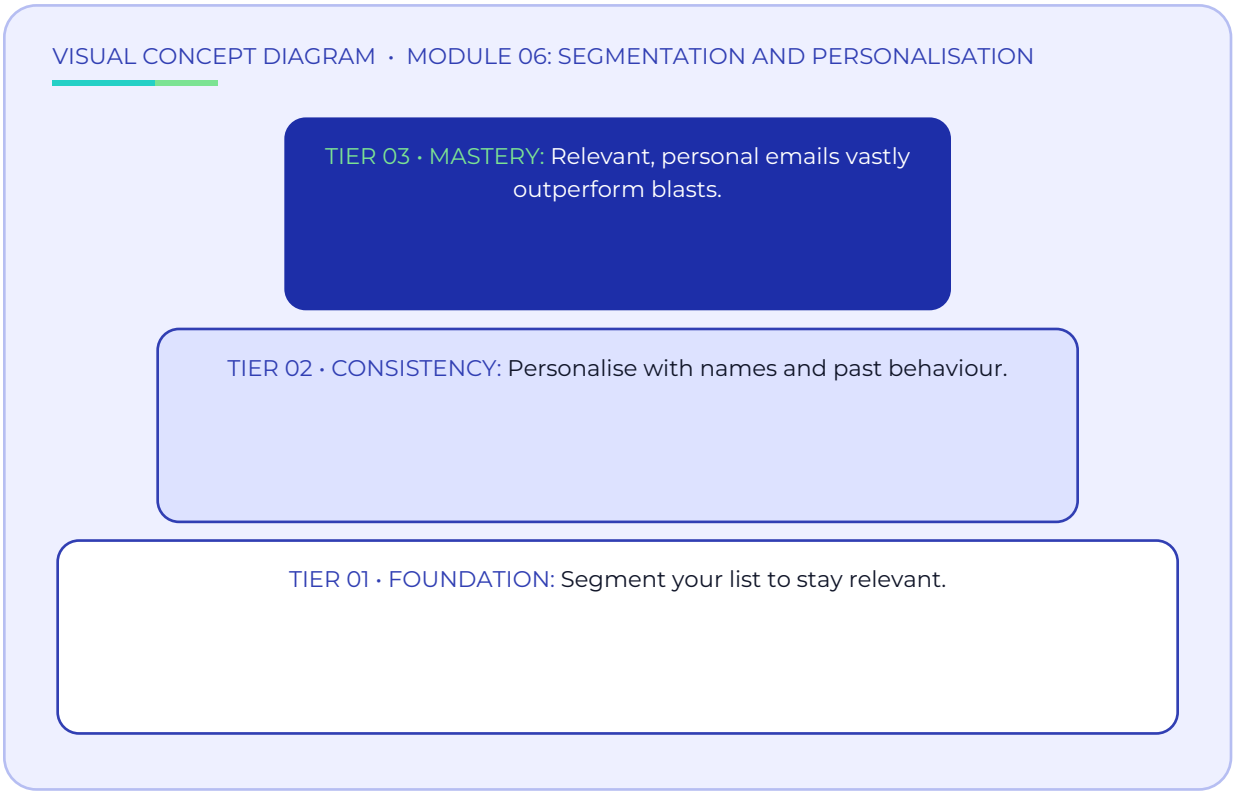
Automation delivers the right message at scale.

3.2 Segmentation and personalisation

Not all subscribers are the same, and treating them identically wastes the power of email. Segmentation means grouping your list (by interest, behaviour, purchase history, or location) so you can send more relevant messages to each group. A relevant email to the right segment vastly outperforms a generic blast to everyone.

Personalisation goes further, using the subscriber's name, referencing their past actions, and tailoring content to feel one-to-one. Modern platforms make this easy. The more relevant and personal your emails feel, the more they're opened, trusted and acted on. People engage with messages that feel like they were written for them, because effectively they were.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *segmentation and personalisation* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real subscriber sequence. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that segment your list to stay relevant., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.



MODULE 06 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Segmentation and personalisation

Core Rule:
Segment your list to stay relevant.

Target Output:
Working subscriber sequence

MODULE 06 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A store sent past buyers of running shoes a targeted email about new running gear, while sending beginners a 'getting started' guide. Both segments responded far better than a single generic email would, relevance drove the results.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Email Marketing workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 06

Your Practical Task: For your business, define two or three subscriber segments and one tailored message you'd send to each.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 06 Key Takeaways

01

Segment your list to stay relevant.

02

Personalise with names and past behaviour.

03

Relevant, personal emails vastly outperform blasts.



04
Scaling, Capstone & Excellence

Module 07: Analytics and optimisation | Module 08: Run a full email campaign

MODULE 07 · PART 1

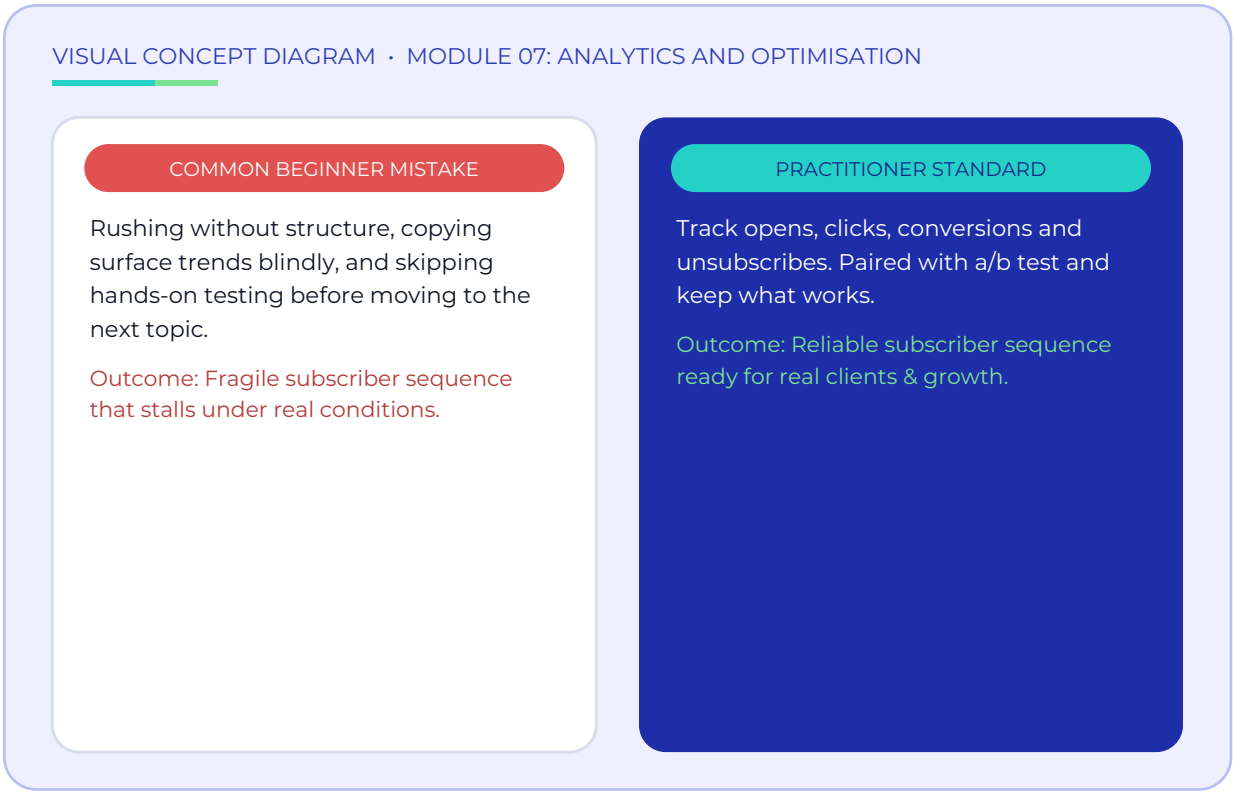
4.1 Analytics and optimisation

Email is highly measurable, so improvement is straightforward if you watch the right numbers. Key metrics: open rate (are subject lines working?), click rate (is the content and call to action compelling?), and conversions (are people actually buying or acting?). Also watch unsubscribes, a spike means you're sending too much or the wrong things.

Use these numbers to improve continuously. Test different subject lines, send times, and content, and keep what performs (this is called A/B testing). Small, steady optimisations compound into big gains over time. The marketer who reads the data and adjusts will always outperform the one who just keeps sending the same emails and hoping.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *analytics and optimisation* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real subscriber sequence. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that track opens, clicks, conversions and unsubscribes., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 07: ANALYTICS AND OPTIMISATION



MODULE 07 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Analytics and optimisation

Core Rule:
Track opens, clicks, conversions and unsubscribes.

Target Output:
Working subscriber sequence

MODULE 07 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A newsletter's opens were low until the sender tested shorter, curiosity-driven subject lines. One style clearly won, opens climbed, and every future email benefited, a simple test, found by watching the data, that paid off repeatedly.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Email Marketing workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 07

Your Practical Task: List the three email metrics you'll track and write one simple A/B test you'd run (e.g. two subject lines) to improve results.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 07 Key Takeaways

01

Track opens, clicks, conversions and unsubscribes.

02

A/B test and keep what works.

03

Small optimisations compound over time.

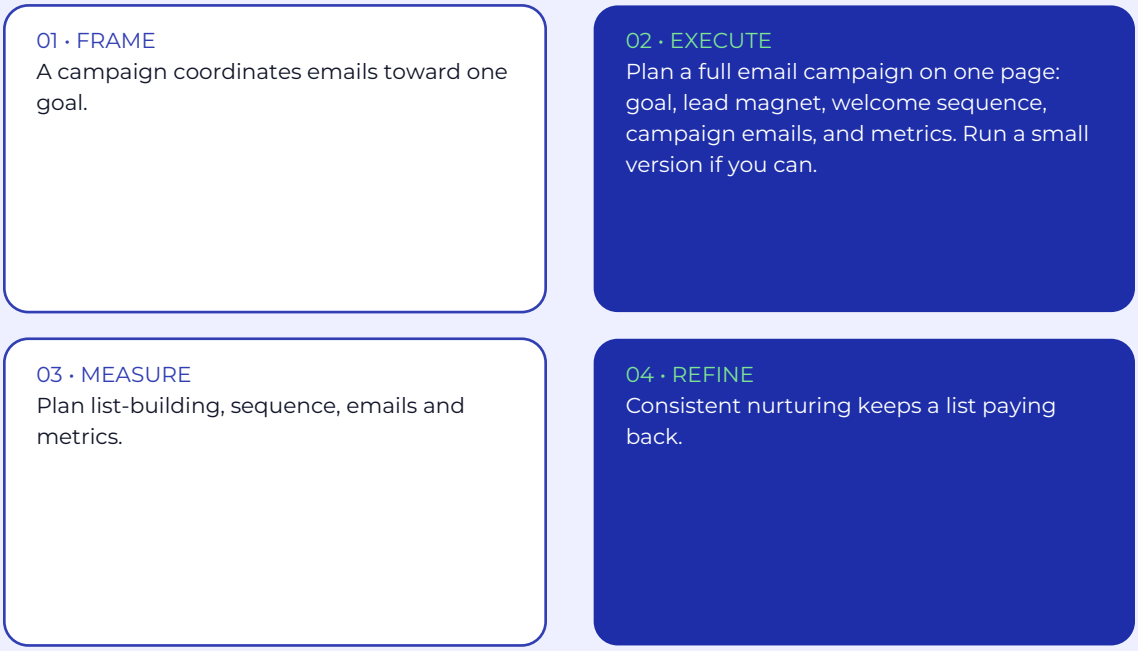
4.2 Run a full email campaign

Your final project ties it all together: plan a complete email campaign for a real or imagined business. Define the goal (e.g. launch a product, drive sales), your lead magnet and how you'll grow the list, your welcome sequence, and the campaign emails themselves, plus how you'll measure success. A campaign is a coordinated set of emails driving toward one objective.

Then, ideally, run it for real, even a small version. Build the list, send the sequence, watch the numbers, and learn. This hands-on experience turns email marketing from theory into a demonstrable skill you can sell to businesses or use to grow your own. Email rewards the consistent: keep nurturing your list and it keeps paying back.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *run a full email campaign* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real subscriber sequence. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that a campaign coordinates emails toward one goal., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 08: RUN A FULL EMAIL CAMPAIGN



MODULE 08 | FIELD BRIEF

Focus Skill:
Run a full email campaign

Core Rule:
A campaign coordinates emails toward one goal.

Target Output:
Working subscriber sequence

MODULE 08 | WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A learner ran a small campaign for a friend's bakery: a free-recipe lead magnet grew a list, a welcome sequence built trust, and a launch email for a new product drove real weekend orders, a full campaign, real results, a proven skill.

How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Email Marketing workbook.

HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 08

Your Practical Task: Plan a full email campaign on one page: goal, lead magnet, welcome sequence, campaign emails, and metrics. Run a small version if you can.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

Module 08 Key Takeaways

01

A campaign coordinates emails toward one goal.

02

Plan list-building, sequence, emails and metrics.

03

Consistent nurturing keeps a list paying back.

5.1 Complete 8-Module Practice & Competency Matrix

Review every module in Email Marketing using the table below. Check off each module only after you have completed its hands-on assignment and verified your work against the core principle.

Module	Focus Topic	Core Principle	Workbook Check
Module 01	Introduction to email marketing	Email reaches an audience you own directly.	Completed [ ]
Module 02	Building your email list	Offer a valuable lead magnet to earn sign-ups.	Completed [ ]
Module 03	Choosing an email platform	Use a proper email platform, not personal Gmail.	Completed [ ]
Module 04	Writing compelling emails	Subject line gets the open; body gets the read.	Completed [ ]
Module 05	Automating email sequences	Set up sequences once; they run automatically.	Completed [ ]
Module 06	Segmentation and personalisation	Segment your list to stay relevant.	Completed [ ]
Module 07	Analytics and optimisation	Track opens, clicks, conversions and unsubscribes.	Completed [ ]
Module 08	Run a full email campaign	A campaign coordinates emails toward one goal.	Completed [ ]

CAPSTONE PORTFOLIO STANDARD

Before graduating from this handbook, combine all eight modules into one finished, shareable subscriber sequence: *Plan a full email campaign on one page: goal, lead magnet, welcome sequence, campaign emails, and metrics. Run a small version if you can.* When ready for mentor feedback, email your work to chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.

5.2 Applied Fellowship Case Reflections

Real transformation happens when learners turn theory into consistent service. Reflect on these cohort case highlights from across East Africa as you prepare your own project:

"A creator with a modest email list of a few hundred true fans launched a product and made more sales than a rival with tens of thousands of passive social followers, because email reached people directly and personally, and they trusted her."

Cohort Case Reflection | Starting Strong in Module 01

STAGE 01

01

STAGE 02

02

"A shop's emails were ignored until they switched from formal 'Dear valued customer' blasts to warm, personal notes with one clear offer and a friendly tone. Opens and sales rose, people respond to a human, not a megaphone."

Mid-Course Breakthrough | Applying Strategy in Module 04

"A learner ran a small campaign for a friend's bakery: a free-recipe lead magnet grew a list, a welcome sequence built trust, and a launch email for a new product drove real weekend orders, a full campaign, real results, a proven skill."

Capstone Completion | Shipping Real Work in Module 08

STAGE 03

03

Stewardship Principle: "Whatever your hand finds to do, do it with excellence, integrity, and faithfulness so your skill becomes a blessing to many."

06 90-Day Action Roadmap

True mastery in Email Marketing is measured by what you build, ship, and steward after finishing the lessons. Follow this structured 90-day implementation plan developed by CHRISCO Youth Aflame (under CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches) to turn study into fruitfulness.

6.1 Four-Stage Post-Course Milestones

01

Days 1 to 14: Foundation Sprint

Complete Modules 1 to 4 labs and document your baseline specimen in Email Marketing.

02

Days 15 to 30: First Live Output

Complete Modules 5 to 8 and ship your first real capstone deliverable: Plan a full email campaign on one page: goal, lead magnet, welcome sequence, campaign emails, and metrics. Run a small version if you can.

03

Days 31 to 60: Feedback & Iteration

Share your work with a mentor, peer, or real client/community audience and refine weak points.

04

Days 61 to 90: Service & Multiplication

Use your skill to serve your church, business, or clients faithfully and mentor one younger learner.

Follow-Up Stage	CHRISCO Support Channel	Contact & Cadence
Workbook Review	CHRISCO Digital Academy Desk	chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
Capstone Submission	CHRISCO Youth Aflame Mentors	shambetz@gmail.com
Peer Accountability	CHRISCO Fellowship Study Hubs	Monthly Cohort Check-In

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Equipping Youth, Elevating Purpose

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